

Advantest (6857)

Substantially raise earnings estimates: SoC market to expand further from mainly GPUs to ASICs and CPUs

We revise our earnings estimates in light of recent trends. We maintain our Overweight rating and raise our end-December 2027 price target to ¥51,000 (previously ¥41,000 through end-2026). We expect SoC tester demand to expand from mainly GPUs to ASICs and CPUs, and also to CPOs over the medium term. Tester demand has risen further as semiconductor chips become more complicated and increase in value-added, and the market is expanding faster than we expected. We had previously expected Advantest's operating profit to grow at a strong +28% CAGR over (FY2025–28), but now raise our outlook significantly to +47%. In addition to the increase in SoC tester ASP we estimate (+5% CAGR over FY2025–28) ; however, we still see further upside), we also factor in an accelerated expansion of production capacity and further TAM growth for ASICs and CPUs.

- **Earnings estimates:** We forecast operating profit to grow 86% YoY to ¥928 billion in FY2026 (previous estimate: ¥778 billion), grow 47% to ¥1,367.3 billion in FY2027 (¥952.7 billion), and 16% to ¥1,579.1 billion in FY2028 (¥1,039.3 billion). GPU test times (total test time including number of processes) can change until just prior to chip shipments, but we lower our estimate from +30% to +5% versus the previous generation. However, we substantially raise our earnings estimates to reflect (1) stronger-than-expected growth in demand for ASICs and CPUs (we expect FY2026 earnings contributions in order of GPUs > ASICs > CPUs); (2) ASP growth for SoC testers (we raise our FY2026 blended ASP estimate from +5% to +10% YoY on changes in the system mix); and (3) shipment growth from accelerating production capacity expansion.
- **Accelerating production capacity expansion:** SoC tester production capacity was 3,000 units/year as of March 2025. Advantest had previously aimed to expand capacity to 5,000 units/year at end-FY2026, and 10,000 units/year in late 2028 to 2029. However, to respond to robust demand for GPUs, ASICs, and CPUs, the company plans to soon reach its end-FY2026 target of 5,000 units/year. We also expect the 10,000 units/year milestone to be pulled forward, reaching it around mid-FY2028.

Overweight

6857.T, 6857.JP

Price (09 Sep 26): ¥32,840

▲ Price Target (Dec-27): ¥51,000

Prior (Dec-26): ¥41,000

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Key Changes (FYE Mar)

	Prev	Cur	Δ
Adj. EPS - 27E (¥)	793.50	994.24	25.3%
Adj. EPS - 28E (¥)	971.72	1,418.02	45.9%

Style Exposure

Quant Factors	Current	Hist %Rank (1=Top)			
	%Rank	6M	1Y	3Y	5Y
Value	98	98	96	94	87
Growth	9	12	32	56	61
Momentum	18	3	7	7	38
Quality	5	32	23	12	27
Low Vol	87	98	94	92	83
ESGQ	85	93	85	8	16

Sources for: Style Exposure – J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy; all other tables are company data and J.P. Morgan estimates.

See page 7 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

Price Performance



	YTD	1m	3m	12m
Abs	67.2%	2.0%	24.7%	158.4%
Rel	48.5%	2.7%	20.9%	128.8%

Company Data

Shares O/S (mn)	732
52-week range (¥)	38,730-12,185
Market cap (\$ bn)	156.1
Exchange rate	153.98
Free float (%)	96.9%
3M ADV (mn)	9.00
3M ADV (\$ mn)	1,826.1
Volatility (90 Day)	78
Index	TOPIX
BBG ANR (Buy Hold Sell)	23 3 0

Key Metrics (FYE Mar)

¥ in millions	2026/3A	2027/3E	2028/3E	2029/3E
Financial Estimates				
Revenue	1,128,610	1,753,300	2,486,500	2,861,900
EBITDA	524,720	956,800	1,402,100	1,618,200
EBIT	499,120	928,000	1,367,300	1,579,100
Net income	375,353	719,800	1,026,600	1,183,300
Reported EPS	517.36	994.24	1,418.02	1,634.47
BBG EPS	460.11	909.26	1,160.74	-
Cashflow from operations	335,182	650,279	864,911	1,134,122
FCFF	302,170	600,279	814,911	1,094,122
Margins and Growth				
Revenue Growth Y/Y (%)	44.7%	55.4%	41.8%	15.1%
EBIT margin	44.2%	52.9%	55.0%	55.2%
EBIT Growth	118.8%	85.9%	47.3%	15.5%
EBITDA margin	46.5%	54.6%	56.4%	56.5%
EBITDA Growth Y/Y (%)	105.6%	82.3%	46.5%	15.4%
Net margin	33.3%	41.1%	41.3%	41.3%
Fully Diluted EPS growth	135.5%	92.2%	42.6%	15.3%
Ratios				
Effective Tax Rate	27.4%	26.0%	26.0%	26.0%
Interest cover	-	-	-	-
Net debt/Equity	NM	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/EBITDA	NM	NM	NM	NM
ROE	57.6%	73.6%	72.1%	59.0%
Valuation				
FCFF yield	1.3%	2.5%	3.4%	4.6%
Dividend yield	0.2%	0.5%	0.6%	0.7%
EV/Revenue	22.1	14.1	9.8	8.3
EV/EBITDA	47.5	25.8	17.4	14.7
P/E	63.5	33.0	23.2	20.1

Summary Investment Thesis and Valuation

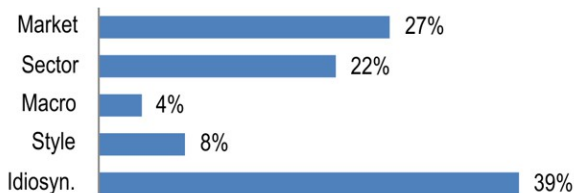
Investment Thesis

Growth in tester needs in connection with the lengthening of test times due to chip advances is a medium-term tailwind. We also expect a focus on Advantest's close ties with key customers in terms of the increasing performance of semiconductors brought about by generative AI advances. Another key factor is whether visibility on ROE upside can be improved through M&A and other capital allocation.

Valuation

Our end-December 2027 price target of ¥51,000 is based on our FY2027 EPS estimate and a P/E of about 36x, which is +0.5 standard deviation from Advantest's past 10-year average of around 29x (we previously used a P/E of about 42x, which was +1 standard deviation from the past 10-year average). Our expectations for strong earnings growth are unchanged, but we adjust the premium we add for Advantest on an industrywide decline in valuations.

Performance Drivers



Factors	6M Corr	1Y Corr
Market: MSCI Japan	0.57	0.52
Sect: Technology	0.48	0.56
Ind: Semicond & S Equip	0.59	0.73
Macro:		
Nikkei Japan Manufacturing PMI	-0.24	-0.24
Japan Generic Govt 10Y Yield	-0.41	-0.23
Japan CPI Nationwide YoY	0.14	0.18
Quant Styles:		
Growth	0.54	0.54
Value	-0.45	-0.52
LowVol	-0.35	-0.49

Table 1: Earnings forecasts

(mn JPY)	2025/3	2026/3					2027/3					2028/3	2029/3	2027/3
	FY Act	1Q Act	2Q Act	3Q Act	4Q Act	FY Act	1Q Act	2Q JPMe	3Q JPMe	4Q JPMe	FY JPMe	FY JPMe	FY JPMe	FY CoE
Sales	779,707	263,776	262,957	273,804	328,073	1,128,610	367,473	419,200	452,400	514,200	1,753,300	2,486,500	2,861,900	1,714,000
Test System Business	682,819	240,554	237,403	245,108	296,325	1,019,390	333,562	388,200	417,600	475,800	1,615,200	2,318,800	2,665,200	1,575,000
Memory Testers	157,700	33,500	43,900	57,300	36,800	171,500	48,000	54,800	68,400	63,600	234,800	306,100	411,000	227,000
SoC Testers	440,400	191,300	173,700	165,200	237,200	767,400	259,600	307,700	319,500	380,300	1,267,100	1,869,800	2,093,500	1,243,500
Other Systems	84,700	15,800	19,800	22,600	22,300	80,500	26,000	25,700	29,700	31,900	113,300	142,900	160,700	104,500
Services & Others	96,888	23,222	25,554	28,706	31,748	109,230	33,911	31,000	34,800	38,400	138,100	167,700	196,700	139,000
Operating income	228,161	123,952	108,483	113,571	153,114	499,120	189,990	219,600	234,700	283,400	928,000	1,367,300	1,579,100	846,000
Semiconductor / Component Test Systems	262,120	126,925	113,631	117,144	161,060	518,760	190,722	216,000	230,000	278,000	915,000	1,347,000	1,553,000	--
Services, Support & Others	-16,125	2,706	342	1,703	4,007	8,758	8,563	8,000	8,800	9,500	34,900	40,800	46,600	--
(Eliminations/Unallocated)	-14,941	-4,616	-4,436	-4,112	-10,784	-23,948	-7,944	-4,400	-4,100	-4,100	-20,500	-20,500	-20,500	--
Profit before tax	224,774	121,357	109,160	113,832	172,371	516,720	234,082	--	--	--	972,700	1,387,300	1,599,100	891,000
Net income	161,177	90,180	79,633	78,713	126,827	375,353	174,780	--	--	--	719,800	1,026,600	1,183,300	660,000
D&A	27,100	6,100	6,300	6,400	6,800	25,600	7,200	6,800	7,100	7,700	28,800	34,800	39,100	31,000
Capex	21,000	6,100	9,400	7,800	1,100	34,300	11,000	15,000	13,000	11,000	50,000	50,000	40,000	50,000
R&D	71,400	17,100	18,300	19,200	23,500	78,100	21,500	24,500	26,500	30,100	102,600	170,400	210,400	110,000
Forex														
USDJPY	153	146	146	152	156	150	159	160	155	155	157	155	155	152

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Table 2: Advantest (6857): Key changes

	Sales (JPYm)	YoY (%)	OP (JPYm)	YoY (%)	PBT (JPYm)	YoY (%)	NP (JPYm)	YoY (%)	EPS (JPY)	P/E (x)
3/24 A	486,507	-13.2%	81,628	-51.3%	78,170	-54.4%	62,290	-52.2%	84.5	400.2
3/25 A	779,707	60.3%	228,161	179.5%	224,774	187.5%	161,177	158.8%	219.7	153.9
3/26 A	1,128,610	44.7%	499,120	118.8%	516,720	129.9%	375,353	132.9%	517.4	65.3
3/27 CoE	1,714,000	51.9%	846,000	69.5%	891,000	72.4%	660,000	75.8%	911.6	37.1
3/27 J.P. Morgan E	1,753,300	55.4%	928,000	85.9%	972,700	88.2%	719,800	91.8%	994.2	34.0
3/27 J.P. Morgan E (old)	1,577,500	39.8%	778,000	55.9%	778,000	50.6%	575,700	53.4%	793.5	42.6
3/27 Bloomberg consensus	1,725,388	52.9%	865,259	73.4%	884,142	71.1%	660,966	76.1%	909.3	37.2
3/28 J.P. Morgan E	2,486,500	41.8%	1,367,300	47.3%	1,387,300	42.6%	1,026,600	42.6%	1,418.0	23.8
3/28 J.P. Morgan E (old)	1,906,500	20.9%	952,700	22.5%	952,700	22.5%	705,000	22.5%	971.7	34.8
3/28 Bloomberg consensus	2,184,344	26.6%	1,124,148	29.9%	1,139,711	28.9%	843,943	27.7%	1,160.7	29.1
3/29 J.P. Morgan E	2,861,900	15.1%	1,579,100	15.5%	1,599,100	15.3%	1,183,300	15.3%	1,634.5	20.7
3/29 J.P. Morgan E (old)	2,103,500	10.3%	1,039,300	9.1%	1,039,300	9.1%	769,100	9.1%	1,060.1	31.9
3/29 Bloomberg consensus	2,565,116	17.4%	1,337,329	19.0%	1,368,314	20.1%	1,000,654	18.6%	1,388.0	24.4

Source: Company reports, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates.
Price as of September 8.

Table 3: Consolidated BS/CF

	2021/3	2022/3	2023/3	2024/3	2025/3	2026/3	2027/3	2028/3	2029/3
	FY	FY	FY	FY	FY	FY	FY	FY	FY
	Act	Act	Act	Act	Act	Act	JPM	JPM	JPM
Summarized BS									
Current assets	279,095	304,945	374,695	420,261	599,753	836,407	1,222,480	1,824,722	2,495,066
Cash and cash equivalents	149,164	116,582	85,537	106,702	262,544	339,966	583,848	901,929	1,444,606
Trade receivables	57,028	82,155	102,152	88,855	113,031	228,731	299,365	440,524	503,943
Inventories	64,340	95,013	169,082	204,389	209,707	231,718	303,275	446,277	510,524
Other	8,563	11,195	17,924	20,315	14,471	35,992	35,992	35,992	35,992
Fixed assets	143,546	189,751	225,529	250,968	254,457	335,409	356,609	371,809	372,709
Tangible fixed assets	41,613	51,392	64,046	78,884	78,602	101,628	122,828	138,028	138,928
Goodwill and intangible assets	54,543	85,307	95,767	98,514	78,365	84,250	84,250	84,250	84,250
Other	47,390	53,052	65,716	73,570	97,490	149,531	149,531	149,531	149,531
Current liabilities	89,811	150,882	174,689	126,277	309,424	330,284	374,154	461,825	501,214
Trade debt	58,558	70,352	89,262	76,863	107,093	142,061	185,931	273,602	312,991
Short-term liabilities	0	18,359	13,357	0	74,952	0	0	0	0
Others	31,253	62,171	72,070	49,414	127,379	188,223	188,223	188,223	188,223
Long-term liabilities	52,461	49,193	56,841	113,774	38,247	45,806	45,806	45,806	45,806
Long-term liabilities	0	12,239	20,000	75,143	3	0	0	0	0
Others	52,461	36,954	36,841	38,631	38,244	45,806	45,806	45,806	45,806
Net assets	280,369	294,621	368,694	431,178	506,539	795,726	1,159,129	1,688,900	2,320,755
Shareholders' equity	280,369	294,621	368,694	431,178	506,539	795,726	1,159,129	1,688,900	2,320,755
Noncontrolling interests	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total assets	422,641	494,696	600,224	671,229	854,210	1,171,816	1,579,089	2,196,531	2,867,775
Net debt	-149,164	-85,984	-52,180	-31,559	-187,589	-339,966	-583,848	-901,929	-1,444,606
Cash and cash equivalents	149,164	116,582	85,537	106,702	262,544	339,966	583,848	901,929	1,444,606
Interest-bearing debt	0	30,598	33,357	75,143	74,955	0	0	0	0
Capital adequacy ratio	66%	60%	61%	64%	59%	68%	73%	77%	81%
Summarized CF									
CF from operating activities	67,830	78,889	70,224	32,668	285,971	335,182	650,279	864,911	1,134,122
Net income	69,787	87,301	130,400	62,290	161,177	375,353	719,800	1,026,600	1,183,300
Depreciation expense	11,756	14,968	21,396	26,104	27,075	25,612	28,800	34,800	39,100
Change in working capital	-2,774	-37,549	-70,736	-30,380	-2,648	-92,441	-98,321	-196,489	-88,278
Others	-10,939	14,169	-10,836	-25,346	100,367	26,658	0	0	0
CF from investing activities	-16,831	-46,907	-26,706	-27,940	-42,189	-34,552	-50,000	-50,000	-40,000
Expenditure on acquisition of fixed assets	-12,415	-17,158	-22,535	-19,592	-17,414	-33,012	-50,000	-50,000	-40,000
Others	-4,416	-29,749	-4,171	-8,348	-24,775	-1,540	0	0	0
CF from financial activities	-30,415	-68,736	-77,434	10,760	-82,818	-230,550	-356,397	-496,830	-551,445
Change in borrowings	0	28,468	32	39,998	0	-75,352	0	0	0
Purchase and sales of treasury stock	-14,028	-70,148	-50,042	-17	-50,080	-114,328	-284,000	-360,000	-390,000
Dividends paid to owner of parent co.	-15,594	-25,456	-25,418	-24,881	-27,320	-35,754	-72,397	-136,830	-161,445
Others	-793	-1,600	-2,006	-4,340	-5,418	-5,116	0	0	0
FCF	50,999	31,982	43,518	4,728	243,782	300,630	600,279	814,911	1,094,122

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Note: FCF above is calculated by Operating CF + Investing CF.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Advantest (6857) (*Overweight; Price Target: ¥51,000*)

Investment Thesis

Growth in tester needs in connection with the lengthening of test times due to chip advances is a medium-term tailwind. We also expect a focus on Advantest's close ties with key customers in terms of the increasing performance of semiconductors brought about by generative AI advances. Another key factor is whether visibility on ROE upside can be improved through M&A and other capital allocation.

Valuation

Our end-December 2027 price target of ¥51,000 is based on our FY2027 EPS estimate and a P/E of about 36x, which is +0.5 standard deviation from Advantest's past 10-year average of around 29x. We add a premium based on earnings growth.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside Scenario to Price Target/Rating

- Increase in share of tester market
- More earnings opportunities as a result of M&A
- Growth in shareholder returns

Downside Scenario to Price Target/Rating

- Decline in share of tester market
- Inefficient capital allocation
- Slower growth in semiconductor capex market
- Deceleration in growth rate of test-time expansion
- Earnings growth moderating as demand shifts from new tester purchases to upgrades

Advantest (6857): Summary of Financials

Income Statement						Cash Flow Statement					
	2025/3A	2026/3A	2027/3E	2028/3E	2029/3E		2025/3A	2026/3A	2027/3E	2028/3E	2029/3E
Revenue	779,707	1,128,610	1,753,300	2,486,500	2,861,900	Cash flow from operating activities	285,971	335,182	650,279	864,911	1,134,122
COGS	(334,622)	(402,503)	(526,800)	(775,200)	(886,800)	o/w Depreciation & amortization	27,075	25,612	28,800	34,800	39,100
Gross profit	445,085	726,107	1,226,500	1,711,300	1,975,100	o/w Changes in working capital	(2,648)	(92,441)	(98,321)	(196,489)	(88,278)
SG&A	(195,392)	(229,628)	(299,200)	(344,000)	(396,000)	Cash flow from investing activities	(42,189)	(34,552)	(50,000)	(50,000)	(40,000)
EBITDA	255,261	524,720	956,800	1,402,100	1,618,200	o/w Capital expenditure	(17,414)	(33,012)	(50,000)	(50,000)	(40,000)
D&A	(27,100)	(25,600)	(28,800)	(34,800)	(39,100)	as % of sales	2.2%	2.9%	2.9%	2.0%	1.4%
EBIT	228,161	499,120	928,000	1,367,300	1,579,100	Cash flow from financing activities	(82,818)	(230,550)	(356,397)	(496,830)	(551,445)
Net Interest	0	0	0	0	0	o/w Dividends paid	(27,320)	(35,754)	(72,397)	(136,830)	(161,445)
PBT	224,774	516,720	972,700	1,387,300	1,599,100	o/w Shares issued/(repurchased)	(50,080)	(114,328)	(284,000)	(360,000)	(390,000)
Tax	(63,597)	(141,367)	(252,900)	(360,700)	(415,800)	o/w Net debt issued/(repaid)	0	(75,352)	0	0	0
Minority Interest	-	-	-	-	-	Net change in cash	160,964	70,080	243,882	318,081	542,678
Net Income	161,177	375,353	719,800	1,026,600	1,183,300	Adj. Free cash flow to firm	268,557	302,170	600,279	814,911	1,094,122
Reported EPS	219.67	517.36	994.24	1,418.02	1,634.47	y/y Growth	1953.8%	12.5%	98.7%	35.8%	34.3%
DPS	39.00	59.00	149.00	213.00	245.00						
Payout ratio	17.8%	11.4%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%						
Shares outstanding	766	732	732	732	732						

Balance Sheet						Ratio Analysis					
	2025/3A	2026/3A	2027/3E	2028/3E	2029/3E		2025/3A	2026/3A	2027/3E	2028/3E	2029/3E
Cash and cash equivalents	262,544	339,966	583,848	901,929	1,444,606	Gross margin	57.1%	64.3%	70.0%	68.8%	69.0%
Accounts receivable	113,031	228,731	299,365	440,524	503,943	EBITDA margin	32.7%	46.5%	54.6%	56.4%	56.5%
Inventories	209,707	231,718	303,275	446,277	510,524	EBIT margin	29.3%	44.2%	52.9%	55.0%	55.2%
Other current assets	337,209	496,441	638,632	922,793	1,050,459	Net profit margin	20.7%	33.3%	41.1%	41.3%	41.3%
Current assets	599,753	836,407	1,222,480	1,824,722	2,495,066	ROE	34.4%	57.6%	73.6%	72.1%	59.0%
PP&E	78,602	101,628	122,828	138,028	138,928	ROA	21.1%	37.1%	52.3%	54.4%	46.7%
LT investments	97,490	149,531	149,531	149,531	149,531	ROCE	30.1%	52.7%	70.3%	71.1%	58.3%
Other non current assets	97,490	149,531	149,531	149,531	149,531	SG&A/Sales	25.1%	20.3%	17.1%	13.8%	13.8%
Total assets	854,210	1,171,816	1,579,089	2,196,531	2,867,775	Net debt/Equity	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
Short term borrowings	74,952	0	0	0	0	Net debt/EBITDA	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
Payables	107,093	142,061	185,931	273,602	312,991	Sales/Assets (x)	1.0	1.1	1.3	1.3	1.1
Other short term liabilities	127,379	188,223	188,223	188,223	188,223	Assets/Equity (x)	1.6	1.6	1.4	1.3	1.3
Current liabilities	309,424	330,284	374,154	461,825	501,214	Interest cover (x)	-	-	-	-	-
Long-term debt	3	0	0	0	0	Operating leverage	297.8%	265.5%	155.2%	113.2%	102.6%
Other long term liabilities	38,247	45,806	45,806	45,806	45,806	Tax rate	28.3%	27.4%	26.0%	26.0%	26.0%
Total liabilities	347,671	376,090	419,960	507,631	547,020	Revenue y/y Growth	60.3%	44.7%	55.4%	41.8%	15.1%
Shareholders' equity	506,539	795,726	1,159,129	1,688,900	2,320,755	EBITDA y/y Growth	136.9%	105.6%	82.3%	46.5%	15.4%
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0	EPS y/y growth	160.4%	135.5%	92.2%	42.6%	15.3%
Total liabilities & equity	854,210	1,171,816	1,579,089	2,196,531	2,867,775						

BVPS						Valuation					
	2025/3A	2026/3A	2027/3E	2028/3E	2029/3E		2025/3A	2026/3A	2027/3E	2028/3E	2029/3E
BVPS	690.37	1,096.77	1,601.08	2,332.84	3,205.61	P/E (x)	149.5	63.5	33.0	23.2	20.1
y/y Growth	18.2%	58.9%	46.0%	45.7%	37.4%	P/BV (x)	47.6	29.9	20.5	14.1	10.2
Net debt/(cash)	(187,589)	(339,966)	(583,848)	(901,929)	(1,444,606)	EV/EBITDA (x)	98.2	47.5	25.8	17.4	14.7
						Dividend Yield	0.1%	0.2%	0.5%	0.6%	0.7%

Source: Company data and J.P. Morgan estimates

Note: ¥ in millions (except per-share data). Fiscal year ends Mar. o/w - out of which

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Advantest (6857) (6857.T, 6857 JP) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 26, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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